Lessons Learned Template · Expert version

A lessons learned template captures what went well, what didn't and why, and turns it into recommendations with owners, so future projects repeat successes and avoid the same mistakes.

How to use this template

1. Collect lessons throughout the project, for example after each phase or sprint.
2. Record what happened and whether it went well or needs improvement.
3. Find the root cause; a 5 whys template helps.
4. Turn each lesson into a recommendation with an owner.
5. Share lessons with the PMO and check actions are completed.

Tips

- Focus on processes, not blame.
- Record successes as well as problems.
- Make recommendations specific and actionable.
- Review past lessons when starting a new project.

Dashboard (sample data)

Field	Value	Count
Owner	Ops lead	1
Owner	PM	1
Owner	PMO	1
Action status	Not started	1
Action status	In progress	1
Action status	Done	1

Lessons learned · Capture lessons during the project, not only at the end

#	Phase / area	What happened	Went well or needs improvement?	Root cause	Impact	Recommendation	Owner	Action status
1	Planning	Requirements signed off two weeks early	Went well	Product owner available daily	Medium	Secure product owner time in the charter	PMO	Done
2	Build	Test environment unavailable for 5 days	Needs improvement	No environment booking process	High	Book environments at planning; add health checks	Ops lead	In progress
3	Communication	Stakeholders unclear on go-live date	Needs improvement	Date changed without update	Medium	Publish dates in a single dashboard	PM	Not started